

Chapter 29 Part 1

DVDs were usually the uncut versions.

As a related industry professional, Liang Shi had always preferred watching DVDs.

After all, to pass censorship, platforms might compress a fifty-minute film to half an hour.

If only some sexual segments were cut, that would be fine, but sometimes it involved bloody/violent factors, cutting the storyline into fragments.

Liang Shi once had a movie that was compressed from nearly two hours to an hour and a half.

After the audience went in, they were greatly disappointed, saying that apart from Liang Shi's acting being commendable, the plot was a pile of shit.

They would watch in the cinema while taking out their phones to curse.

But actually, Liang Shi had seen the finished film. If not a good drama that could score 8 points, it was at least above the 6-point passing line.

That movie ended up with a rating of 3.6.

It became the worst one in Liang Shi's acting career.

After getting into bed, she first turned off the room lights, then adjusted the bedside lamp to the appropriate brightness, enough for them to see the projection clearly without hurting their eyes.

Xu Qingzhu at the side was still busy. Her slender fingers rapidly pressed on the keyboard, moving very fast. Lines of text successively appeared on the screen—it was a proposal from the design department.

Although she had come home early with her, she was still working overtime.

Liang Shi paused the movie that had just shown one scene and sat there playing with her phone, not disturbing her.

Hearing only one sound in the room before it became quiet, Xu Qingzhu took time to lift her head and glance over. Without looking carefully, she asked: "Did it freeze? Is the internet connection bad in the room?"

"No," Liang Shi said. "Waiting for you to finish."

Xu Qingzhu's hands that had been typing on the computer paused. She looked over with slight apology, "Sorry, give me three more minutes to wrap up this proposal."

"Okay," Liang Shi said. "Take your time, no rush."

Actually, she didn't necessarily have to watch a movie.

It was mainly to complete that passive task.

Although she had agreed with Xu Qingzhu to go out for dinner and a movie tomorrow, she was afraid Xu Qingzhu might have something come up at the last minute, which would make her task overdue.

Since there was a suitable opportunity, she might as well do it now.

While waiting for Xu Qingzhu to finish, Liang Shi got up from bed and asked: "Do you want some milk?"

Xu Qingzhu's hands that had been typing stopped, and she looked up at her.

That gaze carried deep inquiry, making Liang Shi think she had done something wrong.

"Why are you suddenly looking at me like that?" Liang Shi tucked the loose hair by her face behind her ear. "It's quite scary."

"Nothing." Xu Qingzhu pressed her temples and naturally changed her expression, saying casually: "Just thought of a new idea, my brain short-circuited for a moment."

"Okay." Liang Shi felt she had disturbed her work and sheepishly touched her nose tip, asking carefully: "So do you need milk?"

Xu Qingzhu returned to work mode. "Yes, no sugar, thank you."

But after saying that, she asked Liang Shi: "Are you sure you want some too?"

"Mm." Liang Shi said: "Drinking milk before bed can help with sleep."

That nightmare was confusing and even had a feeling of being there personally.

That kick from Mrs. Qi at the end seemed to really kick her body, making her hurt as if her internal organs were squeezed together, and she even wanted to cry pitifully.

Liang Shi was afraid that when she entered her dreams later, it would still be those things, so she felt drinking some milk would be better.

Before she went out, Xu Qingzhu said: "The milk is in the cabinet at the far edge of the kitchen."

"Okay."

After Liang Shi left, Xu Qingzhu stared at the door, lost in thought.

Liang Shi actually wanted to drink milk?

Had she really lost her memory?

The reason the milk at home was placed in such a marginal position was completely because Liang Shi was allergic to milk.

Whenever she drank milk, she would break out in red rashes.

She would even get irritable just seeing milk packaging.

But today it was actually Liang Shi who proactively suggested drinking milk.

Even if a person lost their memory, would their living habits change too?

Was that still Liang Shi's body?

Had the other party become Liang Shi through advanced plastic surgery, or through other means?

Xu Qingzhu couldn't figure it out.

She had once compared notes with Zhao Xuning, saying this was Liang Shi.

Very likely just simple amnesia.

But neither of them quite believed this answer.

Xu Qingzhu had been secretly observing her for quite a while. As Zhao Xuning said, regardless of whether she was Liang Shi or not, as long as she performed well, that was fine.

Indeed, her performance during this period was commendable.

That segment at the company also made her and Liang Xinhe look at her with new eyes.

They had always thought Liang Shi was a spoiled, frivolous wastrel, but unexpectedly she could use professional knowledge to render Editor Sun speechless.

Unlike Liang Xinhe, Xu Qingzhu didn't have rose-colored glasses when it came to Liang Shi.

For her, in the four months of marriage with Liang Shi, she had already seen Liang Shi's worst side, so she didn't think this was a prodigal son turning over a new leaf.

But she couldn't analyze anything more.

Moreover, the current Liang Shi was indeed very good.

She was a decent—cooperative partner OR roommate.

Liang Shi, who had gone downstairs, didn't know she had already exposed such a big flaw.

When she went downstairs, the living room lights were still on. Xu Qingya was sitting on the sofa playing games, not even hearing her come down.

It wasn't until Liang Shi unexpectedly appeared in front of her and glanced at the game she was playing that Xu Qingya noticed, startled.

"My God, Sister Liang, how do you walk without making any sound?" Xu Qingya said. "You scared me."

"You were too absorbed in your game." Liang Shi went to the kitchen and found the cabinet Xu Qingzhu mentioned, taking out the milk. "It's so late and you're still not sleeping? Aren't you going to school tomorrow?"

"It's precisely because school starts tomorrow that I want to play like crazy. Otherwise, when I'm buried under mountains of homework, how will I be able to play?" Xu Qingya said while stretching. "Has my sister gone to sleep?"

"Not yet." Liang Shi asked: "Do you want some milk? I'll heat you a cup."

"I already drank some." Xu Qingya said: "I originally wanted to heat two cups and bring them upstairs for you, but I was afraid of disturbing your couple time, so I enjoyed it alone."

Liang Shi: "..."

"What time do you go to school tomorrow?" Liang Shi changed the topic that might go astray.

Xu Qingya said: "Ten in the morning."

"Study hard when you get there." Liang Shi instructed her. "Don't always play games, and definitely don't have puppy love¹."

Xu Qingya shrugged indifferently. "My studies have always been pretty good, and I don't play games or date at school."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Don't lie to me." Liang Shi said: "If I find out you're having puppy love, I'll tell your sister."

Xu Qingya pouted. "Whatever."

Liang Shi poured out the milk and put it in the microwave to heat for three minutes.

Xu Qingya kept standing there, as if she still had something to say.

She was about to ask when she saw Xu Qingya turn around and run back to her room at a trot. Not long after, she ran back with a book in her hand, its cover bright and gaudy.

Xu Qingya handed her the book. "Here."

Liang Shi was puzzled: "What?"

The cover clearly read: "Sweet Daily Life with a Female CEO."

Liang Shi: "...?"

"This is a new book I just discovered. I'm only halfway through." Xu Qingya said: "School starts tomorrow, so I'm reluctantly giving it to you to read."

Liang Shi was about to politely decline when Xu Qingya said: "The plot is really good, absolutely gripping. Don't be put off by its vulgar title. Just persist until the third chapter and I guarantee you won't be able to stop. And..."

Xu Qingya quietly leaned over. "The female CEO in here has a personality very similar to my sister's. I even have the illusion that my sister wrote this book."

Liang Shi: "..."

She was surprised. "You actually insert yourself into dating your sister? That's very..."

"What are you talking about?" Xu Qingya rolled her eyes. "I'm not crazy. I insert myself as the female CEO's sister, watching and shipping the CP² from the sidelines."

Liang Shi: "..."

That was more like it.

But Liang Shi still didn't want it. Last time that novel about a tsundere sweet wife or something was seen by Xu Qingzhu, and Xu Qingzhu was speechless enough.

For those two days, Xu Qingzhu kept bringing up that book from time to time, asking if girls' novels were interesting?

With that somewhat sarcastic tone.

But Xu Qingya said firmly: "You must read this one. Whether you can firmly capture your wife's heart depends on it."

Liang Shi: "..."

The romantically clueless person suddenly believed Xu Qingya's words.

She was even thinking that with this book, she might be able to win over Xu Qingzhu.

Then she could complete the task within three months. Wouldn't that be wonderful?

In that instant, Liang Shi had even thought about what dramas she would act in after getting her original body back and going to the entertainment industry.

She would act in time-travel dramas!

She would definitely become an overnight sensation.

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Liang Shi secretly placed the book Xu Qingya gave her in the study, then brought two cups of milk upstairs.

Xu Qingzhu had just finished the proposal she was working on, took off her glasses, and was massaging her eyes.

She didn't forget to ask: "Has Yaya gone to sleep?"

Liang Shi hesitated for two seconds, considering whether to cover for Xu Qingya or tell the truth. Her brain unconsciously answered: "Not yet."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"It's almost twelve o'clock." Xu Qingzhu got up and was about to go out. "She still has school tomorrow. I'll go..."

Before she finished speaking, she was stopped by Liang Shi, who immediately said: "I already sternly criticized her, and she realized her mistake. She's gone back to her room to sleep now. If you go downstairs and wake her up again, that wouldn't be good."

Xu Qingzhu was skeptical. "Really?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She had just transferred ten thousand yuan in pocket money to Xu Qingya and coaxed her back to her room to sleep.

But regardless, the objective was achieved.

So this time she nodded firmly. "Definitely. Would I do something duplicitous?"

Xu Qingzhu: "You would."

Liang Shi: "..."

What about trust between people?

However, although Xu Qingzhu said this, she didn't actually go downstairs to check.

She placed the computer by the bedside, sat on the bed holding the hot milk, and glanced at the projection. "This is an H-country³ movie?"

"Mm." Liang Shi said: "The color tone looks like an old film."

Xu Qingzhu suddenly fell silent, then asked: "Is this the one you watched that night?"

Liang Shi: "...How could it be?!"

Like a cat whose tail had been stepped on, her voice immediately rose in pitch. "What I watched that night was a domestic movie, and a proper film."

"I didn't say it wasn't proper." Xu Qingzhu chuckled lightly. "Why are you so agitated?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Caught again.

Damn it.

"First, let me clarify that the housekeeper bought all the DVDs, and I haven't watched them either."
Liang Shi said: "If there's anything in the film, please view it with an artistic eye."

Xu Qingzhu nodded perfunctorily. "Oh."

She took a sip of milk. It was a bit hot, so she switched to gently sipping it, and said to Liang Shi:
"Let's start."

Liang Shi started it.

The scenes on the projection began to change, the BGM also played, and combined with the warm yellow lighting, it was quite a cozy picture.

Liang Shi said: "It's a suspense film. If you get scared later, we'll turn it off."

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Okay."

After a while, she suddenly asked: "What was the name of the movie you watched that night?"

Liang Shi shook her head. "I forgot. Let me check the viewing history for you."

She opened the video app and brought up the history to look. "The name is 'Come with Me to See the Ocean in Summer.'"

"An art film." Xu Qingzhu said: "That really is a proper movie."

Liang Shi: "..."

How could she explain to make Xu Qingzhu believe she was a proper person?

Xu Qingzhu looked at the projection and suddenly said faintly: "This also seems to be an art film."

"Suspense film." Liang Shi said decisively: "The tags say so."

Xu Qingzhu: "Alright."

After that, neither of them spoke, quietly watching.

This movie's color tone was rather gray and dark, and some shots were indeed quite puzzling.

But suspense films were all like this. Basically, you could only understand them at the end.

If the audience still couldn't understand by the end, then it was a science fiction film.

Or a failed suspense film.

At first, all the segments were normal, with scenes passing by one by one and settings constantly changing.

But from where did it start going wrong?

It seemed to be from where the maid was checking the young lady's teeth—everything was filled with ambiguous atmosphere.

Footnotes:

¹ Puppy love (早恋): Young romance, typically referring to romantic relationships among teenagers that are often discouraged by parents and teachers in Chinese culture.

² CP: "Couple Pairing" - fan term for shipping fictional characters together in a romantic relationship.

³ H-country: Likely referring to a specific country whose name starts with "H" but is being abbreviated in the original text, possibly for stylistic or censorship reasons.

Chapter 29 Part 3

Liang Shi waited for the milk to cool down, then finished it in two gulps without any reaction.

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her sideways. Liang Shi smiled and asked: "Why are you looking at me?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head and refocused on the movie, saying casually: "You drank it really fast."

In the movie, the young lady was supposed to marry the count, but it quickly turned into the young lady ringing a bell in the room, calling for the maid to come accompany her.

The maid asked her: "Are you really going to marry the count?"

The young lady lured her step by step, first saying yes, then saying she was still inexperienced and didn't know if the count would be satisfied with her. She asked the maid how the count would treat her on their wedding night.

The two lay on the same bed. The maid suddenly got up, took a lollipop from the drawer, licked it a few times, then slowly leaned over.

Her lips touched the young lady's lips.

Though clearly an innocent maid who knew nothing, under the young lady's step-by-step seduction, she slipped her hand into the young lady's clothing, where there was unknown softness.

She said: "The count will treat you this way."

The young lady swallowed and still asked fearfully, "Will he be this gentle?"

The two lead actresses were quite attractive, and their line delivery was decent. When these lines came from their mouths, combined with the high-quality speakers in the room, it seemed as if every word was being played directly in Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu's ears.

Liang Shi watched the projection, feeling slightly embarrassed. She quietly looked at Xu Qingzhu, wanting to suggest turning it off.

But Xu Qingzhu watched expressionlessly without any reaction.

Liang Shi: "..."

She could already feel heat flowing through her lower abdomen.

It had to be said, this movie was filmed very sensually.

Every shot was perfectly executed, and both actresses were very open.

If Liang Shi were watching alone, she would certainly be unperturbed. She might even study how this scene was filmed, when they cut to close-ups and when to wide shots.

But now with another person beside her, she couldn't remain completely detached and found herself getting drawn in.

On screen, the two became increasingly passionate. The maid moved downward, both hands gripping the young lady's legs.

As if hinting at something.

What would happen next seemed easy to imagine. Liang Shi coughed softly, "Should we turn it off?"

Xu Qingzhu frowned. "What's wrong? Isn't this normal for art films?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Could Xu Qingzhu accept content this explicit?

"They dimmed the lights." Xu Qingzhu said: "The plot is quite engaging. Let's continue watching."

Liang Shi turned back and saw the scene had changed, breathing a sigh of relief.

Good, they didn't continue filming that.

But she didn't know that scene was filmed—they just used intercutting¹ techniques.

Suddenly Liang Shi felt her hands were very itchy. She scratched a few times and felt her arms were itchy too.

At first she didn't pay attention, but after a while, she felt some stinging pain where she had absentmindedly scratched. Looking down, she saw dense small red rashes had appeared on the back of her hands.

The movie had already progressed to the second half and began layer upon layer of plot twists.

It was during these reversals that a flashback suddenly appeared—the unfinished intimate scene from before.

Footnotes:

¹ Intercutting: A film editing technique where two or more scenes are intercut to create tension, show parallel action, or create thematic connections between different storylines or timeframes.